
Hackles Club: Certificate and Badge Design Brief

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · quillsup.org · October 2026

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials CC BY-NC 4.0. The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]

[Logo: Hackles]

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · quillsup.org

Status: DRAFT. [VERIFY] and [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM] flags must be cleared before publication.

Part 1: The certificates (print as they are)

PRINT ON COLORED PAPER if you have it. Fill in the name by hand. A child may use a made-up Club name. Leave the date blank or write the month.

CERTIFICATE A: LITTLE HACKLES (AGES 5-7)

FIELD NOTE	No. 1
[Logo: Hackles] Hackles Club This certificate says that ----- is a Little Hackle! I can do Hackles up, Pause, Check, Tell. I know a false alarm is fine. I know it is never my fault. I know grown-ups I can tell. Signed by a leader: _____ Date: _____ <i>Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell</i>	

CERTIFICATE B: HANDS-ON HACKERS (AGES 8-11)

FIELD NOTE	No. 2
[Logo: Hackles] Hackles Club: Hands-On Hackers This certificate says that ----- has practiced spotting SPOT clues, building long, silly, secret passphrases, using the Help Ladder and saying "I need help with something online." A false alarm is welcome. It is never your fault. Signed by a leader: _____ Date: _____ <i>Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell</i>	

CERTIFICATE C: CASE FILES (AGES 12-15)

FIELD NOTE	No. 3
[Logo: Hackles] Hackles Club: Case Files This certificate says that ----- has practiced finding FLAGS, naming a second channel, defending an account, and using the Tell-3 script. Signed by a leader: _____ Date: _____ <i>Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell</i>	

CERTIFICATE D: FAMILY NIGHT

FIELD NOTE	No. 4
[Logo: Hackles] Hackles Family Night A family has practiced Hackles up, Pause, Check, Tell, together. We agree: when you tell us something, we will say "Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault." Signed by a leader: _____ Date: _____	

CERTIFICATE E: HELPER (FOR TEENS AND PARENT VOLUNTEERS)

FIELD NOTE	No. 5
[Logo: Hackles] Hackles Club Helper Thank you, ----- for being a safe adult (or a kind older friend) at Hackles Club. Signed by a leader: _____ Date: _____	

CERTIFICATE RULES

- Give a certificate to every child who attended, not to a few. No ranking, no "best".
- Say the child's name warmly. Say, "You are a Little Hackle" or "You did the work."
- Never write a score, a grade or a comment about behavior.
- A certificate is not a record. The Club keeps no list of who received one.
- Alternative text for a screen reader: each certificate has the same text in the document body.

Part 2: The Hackles Club badge, design brief for the illustrator

WHO THIS IS FOR

AN ILLUSTRATOR WHO WILL draw one badge and a small family of related marks for the Hackles Club: Out-of-School Edition. Read the Hackles Art Direction Brief and Character Bible first (the project owner will send them). The colors, character design and line style come from there and win if anything here differs.

WHAT TO MAKE

#	ASSET	USE	NOTES
1	Hackles Club badge (the main one)	Sticker, paper badge, iron-on patch, sign	A round or rounded-square badge, about 2 inches across
2	Level 1 patch: Notice	Hackles Patch Level 1	Same family as the badge, one distinct symbol
3	Level 2 patch: Practice	Hackles Patch Level 2	Same family, a second symbol
4	Level 3 patch: Teach	Hackles Patch Level 3	Same family, a third symbol
5	Passport stamp set (8 small stamps)	Hackles Passport	One per skill area: Notice, Pause, Check, Tell, Lock It, Share Smart, Kind and Calm, Fix It
6	Certificate border	Four certificates (Part 1)	A simple border and a corner icon, black and white version too
7	Sticker sheet	Take-home	Hackle with quills up, Hackles Up hand, Pause Palm, Tell Wave, Latch, Peeper, Pip, Buddy, Ember, Fixit

THE BADGE: THE IDEA

A friendly round badge that says "this person knows how to notice and tell."

Centre: Hackle (a baby hedgehog with soft pale-yellow, tangerine-tipped quills) with the quills **standing up and a tiny sparkle**, big kind eyes, rosy cheeks, a smile. Gender-neutral. Not Sonic: no blue, no sneakers, no speed gags, no attitude.

Ring text (top): HACKLES CLUB.

Ring text (bottom): TRUST YOUR HACKLES.

Four small icons around the ring for the four moves: a hand brushing up the back of the neck (Hackles up), a flat palm (Pause), a magnifier (Check), a hand on a heart reaching out (Tell).

LOOK AND FEEL

- **Style:** warm, flat, friendly, with ink outlines (#2B2D42). Simple shapes. Readable at 1 inch.
- **Palette** (from the Art Direction Brief): Sunshine yellow #FFC93C, Tangerine #FF8A3D, Coral #FF6B6B, Sky #5BC0EB, Mint #9BE564, Teal #2EC4B6, Grape #8E6BBF, Cream #FFF8E7, Ink #2B2D42. Ink is for text and outlines only, never a large fill.
- **Border:** a simple scalloped or plain circle. **Do not copy or imitate the shape, border style, ribbons, sashes, ranks or iconography of any scouting or other youth organisation's awards.** If a design reminds you of one, change it.
- **No real-world logos, characters or marks** of any other organisation.
- **Text:** a rounded sans-serif. Use the typeface in the Hackles design system if it applies. Never a script font that kids cannot read.

THE THREE LEVEL PATCHES

Each level patch has **a different shape and a different symbol**, so color is never the only clue.

LEVEL	NAME	SHAPE	SYMBOL	COLOR ACCENT
1	Notice	Circle	Quills popping up with a sparkle	Sunshine yellow
2	Practice	Rounded square	A pause palm and a magnifier together	Sky
3	Teach	Hexagon	Two hands passing a small flame (Ember) or a heart reaching out	Teal

The design should feel like a family. A child who has all three could put them in a row.

ACCESSIBILITY

- Text high-contrast against the background. Test in grayscale.
- Never rely on color alone. Each level has its own shape and symbol.
- The symbols must read at 1 inch.
- For a screen reader, supply a short alt text for each asset (for example: "Hackles Club badge: a baby hedgehog with soft pale-yellow, tangerine-tipped quills popped up, inside a ring that reads Hackles Club").

DELIVERABLES AND SPECS

Follow the Hackles technical specs for artwork (the project owner will send them).

- **Vector master** (SVG) for every asset, outlined text, flat vector.

- **PNG** at 300 dpi, sRGB, transparent background, 2000 px wide for the main badge and 1024 x 1024 for each level patch.
- A **black-and-white line version** for photocopying.
- A **one-color version** (ink only) for stamps.
- A **print sheet**: US Letter portrait, 8.5 x 11 in (2550 x 3300 px at 300 dpi) with six badges to cut out.
- Name files `hackles_club_badge.svg`, `hackles_patch_level1_notice.svg`, and so on.
- **Embroidery notes (optional)**. If an iron-on patch is ever made, supply a simplified version with at most 5 colors and no fine lines under 1 mm [VERIFY with a patch maker].

NOT TO DO

- Do not draw Gifty (the Too-Good Box) on any badge. Gifty is a trickster for games, not an award mascot. [ART REQUEST: Gifty art is not yet in `kit/09_Art/characters/`.]
- Do not draw Hackle as a dog or as any recognizable species.
- Do not use the word "scout" or "merit badge" on any asset.
- Do not use a flag, an eagle, a fleur-de-lis, a trefoil, a clover with four leaves, or any other emblem that other youth organisations use.
- Do not add a date or a number that could imply a rank.
- Do not include any child's face or likeness.

STATEMENT ON EVERY BADGE SHEET AND PATCH CARD

Print this small text on the back of the sticker sheet or the patch card:

TO VERIFY

Hackles Club patch. Not affiliated with any scouting or other youth organisation. © 2026 Competence Collective. The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by the CC BY-NC license; print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use. [VERIFY with counsel]

REVIEW AND RIGHTS

- Follow the commission and rights terms the project owner provides in writing.
- Before any manufactured product (iron-on patches, enamel pins, stickers for sale), run a **trademark and design check** [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM].
- The badge is free to print for Club use. It is not for sale.

TIMELINE

STEP	WHEN
Sketches (3 badge ideas)	Week 1
Review with Competence Collective	Week 2
Final art and all 7 assets	Week 4
Test print and grayscale check	Week 5